

Nate Harris, RHP, Kentucky

2026 Stats: 6.07 ERA/46 IP/1.435 WHIP/43 K/24 BB/1.79 K:BB

6-4, 225

Metrics

FB: 92.3/18.4 IVB/9.3 HB/-4.72 VAA/6.2 ext/6.1 relH/36.4% zone/41 AA/44.5% usage/2260 rpm

SI: 91.4/10 IVB/15.2 HB/-6.2 VAA/40.7% zone/33 AA/10.5% usage/2230 rpm

SL: 83.9/4.1 IVB/-1.4 HB/-7.74 VAA/32.6% zone/39.3 AA/38.5% usage/2350 rpm

CH: 86.8/9.7 IVB/14.7 HB/-6.79 VAA/24.1% zone/35.7 AA/6.6% usage/1760 rpm

Write-up

Harris possesses a prototypical starter's frame at 6-foot-4, 225 pounds and works with a four-pitch mix headlined by a hard slider. The overall arsenal is fairly straightforward: an average four-seam fastball, a complementary sinker used primarily to protect the four-seam against right-handed hitters, and flashes of a usable changeup. The results were underwhelming in 2026 as he struggled to consistently throw quality strikes and finish hitters, but the ingredients for a workable professional arsenal remain present. The slider is currently the lone above-average offering and will need to continue carrying the profile while the fastball command and changeup develop. Without another pitch taking a step forward, Harris projects most comfortably in a relief role, though there is still enough repertoire depth to leave the door open for a back-end starter role in the future.

The FB carries above-average ride from a relatively high release while also generating meaningful arm-side movement. The combination creates a difficult visual for hitters when located to the top third of the zone. Despite the solid shape, the pitch lacked consistent execution in 2026. Harris frequently missed into the heart of the zone and struggled to establish the fastball in leverage counts. The movement profile suggests the pitch should play better than the results, but until he consistently gets it to the upper rail and glove-side edge, hitters will continue to get comfortable swings against it. The traits are starter quality, but the command remains below average. 45/50 pitch

The sinker gives Harris a second fastball look and carries solid arm-side run with average sink. The pitch works best against right-handed hitters when located down and into the hands, creating weak contact and ground balls. He generally showed better strike-throwing ability with the sinker than the four-seam, but the shape is not impactful enough to carry significant value on its own. It functions more as a complement to the four-seam than a true weapon. Increased usage against righties could help diversify the attack plan and protect the FB. 40/45 pitch

The slider is the best pitch in the arsenal. It presents as a hard gyro-style breaking ball with modest sweep and solid depth. The velocity band is particularly attractive, sitting in the mid-80s while maintaining shape and topping out in the high 80's. Harris showed confidence throwing it in all counts and it projects as his primary bat-missing pitch moving forward. The command was inconsistent at times with too many SL catching the upper half of the zone, but he demonstrated enough feel to locate beneath the zone and glove-side when it was on. Continued refinement of the command could push the pitch comfortably above average. 50/55 pitch

The changeup is intriguing despite limited usage. It mirrors the sinker's movement profile with significant arm-side fade and enough velocity separation to disrupt timing. The pitch flashes average-to-above-average traits, particularly when located down and away to left-handed hitters. The biggest issue is confidence and consistency; Harris simply did not throw it often enough to fully evaluate the long-term role. Oddly, it failed to garner swings or chase in 2026 despite the firm ASR it created. More usage would not only help neutralize lefties but also improve his starter viability. 45/50 pitch